FOR ACCOUNTANTS + BOOKKEEPERS

# 10 Fable 5 Prompts for a 2-Hour Month-End Close.

Claude Fable 5 is the strongest model Anthropic has ever shipped — and these prompts run on any Claude model you already pay for. These 10 prompts turn it into your **close checklist builder, reconciliation triage desk, and client-communication department** — each one built for the work that actually eats the first week of your month.

**WORKS ON ANY CLAUDE MODEL**

Fable 5 is included on Max and Team Premium plans (up to 50% of your weekly limits). On Pro and Team Standard it runs on usage credits. Every prompt in this pack is model-agnostic — it works on whichever Claude model you have.

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|---|---|---|
| COPY-PASTE PROMPTS | PARTS PER PROMPT: ROLE TO FORMAT | REUSABLE ASSET PER PROMPT |

# How to run these in 3 steps.

No technical setup. If you can paste a trial balance, you can run every prompt in this pack.

**1**

### Open Claude and pick Fable 5

Go to `claude.ai` (or Claude Code if you use it) and select **Fable 5** in the model picker. On Max and Team Premium it is included, up to 50% of your weekly usage; on Pro it runs on usage credits. Any Claude model will run these prompts.

**2**

### Paste the prompt, fill the [BRACKETS]

Copy a prompt from this pack exactly as written. Everything in `[UPPERCASE BRACKETS]` is yours to fill — the trial balance export, the unreconciled items, your close process as it really runs. The more real detail you paste, the better the output. Fable 5 handles huge amounts of context, so do not summarize — paste the whole export.

**3**

### Save the output as a template

Every prompt here produces something reusable — a close calendar, a PBC chase sequence, an engagement-scope framework. Save each one. That is the point: you keep the asset long after any one model's pricing changes.

**Pro habit: end every session with one more line.**

Before you close the chat, type: "Turn what you just built into a fill-in-the-blanks template I can reuse for every future client and every future close." Fable 5 will package its own work. That template is yours forever.

## 01 The Month-End Close Calendar Builder

**When to use:** once — turn the close that lives in your head into a sequenced calendar the whole team can run.

```
You are a controller who has systematized month-end close for dozens of small firms.

GOAL: Turn my messy real-world close process into a sequenced close calendar with an owner and a done-condition per task, plus a reusable monthly checklist.

CONTEXT: How my close actually runs today, in order, including the chaos: [BRAIN-DUMP EVERY TASK — RECS, ACCRUALS, PAYROLL TIE-OUT, REVIEW, REPORTING]. Who touches it: [TEAM + ROLES]. Current close time: [HONEST DAYS]. The tasks that always slip: [NAME THEM].

CONSTRAINTS: Sequence by dependency, not habit. One owner per task, never "team". Flag pre-close tasks and anything needing professional judgment for reviewer sign-off.

PROCESS: Map dependencies first, sequence into close days 1-5, then compress: challenge every task that claims it must wait.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Close calendar table (day, task, owner, done-condition), pre-close list, and the blank monthly checklist.
```

PRO TIP Brain-dump the chaos honestly — the compression step only works on the real process, not the ideal one.

## 02 The Bank-Rec Exception Triage Desk

**When to use:** the moment a reconciliation will not tie — before you burn an afternoon scrolling transactions.

```
You are a senior bookkeeper who clears reconciliation exceptions fast because you categorize before you investigate.

GOAL: Triage my unreconciled items into categories with a specific next action for each, so I clear the rec in one pass instead of item-by-item archaeology.

CONTEXT: The account: [BANK / CC ACCOUNT + PERIOD]. The difference: [AMOUNT]. Unreconciled items, pasted raw: [DATE / DESCRIPTION / AMOUNT FOR EVERY OPEN ITEM]. Known quirks: [TIMING, DUPLICATES, FEES].

CONSTRAINTS: Use only the items I pasted — never invent a transaction or an explanation. Categories: timing difference, likely duplicate, missing entry, bank fee/interest, needs client answer, unknown. Unclassifiable items go to unknown with the exact question that resolves them — no guessing. Not tax or audit advice; flag judgment calls for review.

PROCESS: Find offsetting pairs and near-matches first, classify the rest, then total each category against the difference.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Triage table (item, category, evidence, next action), category totals vs the difference, and the client-question list.
```

PRO TIP Paste both sides — bank feed AND ledger — as two labeled blocks. Offset-matching is where the hours come back.

## 03 The Variance-Analysis Narrative Writer

**When to use:** every month-end reporting pack — turn the P&L comparison into an explanation a client actually reads.

```
You are a fractional CFO who explains variances to business owners in plain language, without inventing a single cause.

GOAL: Write the variance commentary for my client's monthly pack — what moved, how much, and why where I know why — in owner-friendly language.

CONTEXT: P&L for [MONTH] vs [PRIOR MONTH / BUDGET / SAME MONTH LAST YEAR]: [PASTE BOTH COLUMNS]. What I know happened this month: [PRICE CHANGES, ONE-OFFS, NEW HIRES — ONLY WHAT YOU KNOW]. The client: [BUSINESS TYPE + WHAT THEY CARE ABOUT].

CONSTRAINTS: Only the numbers I pasted — never invent a figure or a cause. Unknown cause = write "ASK CLIENT:" with the exact question, never speculate. Lead with the 3-5 material variances; one line each for the rest. Not tax advice; flag anything needing professional judgment.

PROCESS: Compute variances, rank by materiality, attach known causes, mark the rest ASK CLIENT, then write.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Summary paragraph, per-variance commentary, ASK CLIENT question list.
```

**PRO TIP** Send the ASK CLIENT list before the meeting — the client fills the gaps and the commentary finishes itself.

## 04 The Messy-Books Cleanup Diagnostic

**When to use:** every inherited file — scope the cleanup before you quote it, not after you are drowning in it.

```
You are a cleanup specialist who diagnoses neglected books before touching a single entry.

GOAL: Diagnose this client file and give me a prioritized cleanup plan — what is broken, what to fix first, and what it means for my quote.

CONTEXT: Trial balance: [PASTE IT]. GL sample from the accounts that look wrong: [PASTE 50-200 LINES]. What the client told me: [THEIR STORY]. Red flags I already spotted: [NEGATIVE BALANCES, SUSPENSE ACCOUNTS, STALE AR/AP].

CONSTRAINTS: Diagnose only from the data I pasted — every finding cites the account and evidence. Rank by risk to financial-statement accuracy, not by size alone. Separate mechanical fixes from needs-client-answer from needs-professional-judgment. Not tax or audit advice.

PROCESS: Scan the TB for structural problems, drill into the GL sample, then sequence fixes so early ones do not get undone.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Findings table (issue, evidence, risk, fix type), sequenced plan, client-question list.
```

**PRO TIP** Run this before quoting any cleanup job — the findings table doubles as your scope justification.

## 05 The PBC Document-Chasing Sequence

**When to use:** build once — then every "still waiting on the bank statements" chase runs on pre-written messages.

```
You are a client-communication specialist for accounting firms whose superpower is getting documents back without nagging.

GOAL: Build my document-chasing system: the initial request that actually gets read, reminders at days 3, 7, and 10, and the escalation that names the consequence — a delayed close — all in my voice.

CONTEXT: What I request monthly: [STATEMENTS, RECEIPTS, LOAN DOCS, PAYROLL REPORTS]. How clients send things now: [PORTAL / EMAIL / SHOEBOX]. My chronic late senders: [HONEST]. My voice: [PASTE 2 EMAILS YOU HAVE SENT CLIENTS].

CONSTRAINTS: Every message skimmable in 10 seconds — the missing-items list sits at the top, never buried. Reminders reference only what is still outstanding. Escalation states the consequence plainly, no guilt-tripping. Nothing that reads like automation.

PROCESS: Write the initial request first, then each reminder as a shorter cut of it, then the escalation.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Five ready-to-send messages with subject lines, plus a blank [CLIENT] / [ITEMS] version for reuse.
```

**PRO TIP** The day-3 reminder recovers the most documents — most firms wait until day 10 and lose the week.

## 06 The Recurring Journal Entry SOP Writer

**When to use:** when the recurring entries live in one person's head — usually yours — and every close depends on remembering them.

```
You are a technical writer for accounting teams who documents processes so a competent newcomer can run them unsupervised.

GOAL: Turn my recurring journal entries into a documented SOP — purpose, calculation, and verification for each — so close no longer depends on my memory.

CONTEXT: My recurring entries: [LIST EACH: ACCOUNTS, CALCULATION, FREQUENCY — DEPRECIATION, ACCRUALS, PREPAIDS, PAYROLL, DEFERRALS]. Source data for each: [WHERE THE NUMBERS COME FROM]. Past mistakes with these entries: [HONEST — THESE BECOME THE WARNINGS].

CONSTRAINTS: Written for a competent bookkeeper who has never seen this file. Every entry gets a verification step. Past mistakes become explicit "watch out" notes. Flag entries involving estimates or judgment as reviewer-sign-off items — not tax advice.

PROCESS: Document each entry, then audit: could a newcomer run this month's entries from the SOP alone? Patch every gap.

OUTPUT FORMAT: One SOP block per entry (purpose, source, calculation, posting steps, verification, watch-outs), then a one-page close-day quick list.
```

**PRO TIP** This SOP is also your vacation insurance — the first close you skip without panic pays for the hour it took.

## 07 The New-Client Onboarding Questionnaire

**When to use:** before every new bookkeeping client — the questions you ask in week one decide how month three feels.

```
You are an onboarding specialist for bookkeeping firms who has seen every way an engagement goes sideways.

GOAL: Build my new-client onboarding questionnaire and document-request pack, so nothing surfaces as a surprise in month three.

CONTEXT: My typical client: [INDUSTRY, SIZE, ENTITY TYPES]. Services: [BOOKKEEPING / PAYROLL / REPORTING]. My stack: [SOFTWARE + APPS]. Surprises that have burned me before: [UNDISCLOSED ACCOUNTS, PERSONAL SPENDING, HIDDEN LOANS].

CONSTRAINTS: Every question exists to prevent a specific future problem — cut pure curiosity. Grouped by topic, plain language, no jargon. Include the access checklist (bank feeds, payroll, merchant, prior accountant). Flag answers needing professional judgment before I commit to scope.

PROCESS: Work backward from my surprises to the questions that catch them, then cover standard ground.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Sectioned questionnaire, document/access checklist, and a red-flags list keyed to answers.
```

PRO TIP The red-flags list is the quiet gold — it tells you which answers mean "raise the price" before you sign.

## 08 The Advisory Upsell One-Pager

**When to use:** when a bookkeeping client keeps asking "so how are we doing?" — that question is an advisory engagement waiting to be named.

```
You are a practice-growth advisor who moves bookkeepers from compliance to paid advisory without overpromising.

GOAL: Turn what I already do for [CLIENT] into an advisory one-pager plus the script for offering it at [MONTHLY PRICE].

CONTEXT: What I currently deliver: [THE COMPLIANCE WORK]. Questions this client actually asks me: [THEIR REAL WORDS]. What their numbers show that they ignore: [MARGIN TRENDS, CASH CYCLES — WHAT YOU SEE]. My honest capacity: [HOURS/MONTH].

CONSTRAINTS: Only promise deliverables I listed capacity for — no "strategic partner" fluff. Frame value as decisions made sooner, not reports received. No invented outcomes or savings claims. Tax strategy gets flagged "requires tax professional" — this is management insight, not tax advice.

PROCESS: Map their questions to deliverables, define the monthly rhythm, then write both pieces.

OUTPUT FORMAT: One-pager (name, what you get, rhythm, price) plus the 5-line opener.
```

PRO TIP Use the client's own questions as the one-pager headings — they cannot say no to their own words.

## 09 The Scope-Creep-Proof Engagement Letter

**When to use:** every new engagement and every renewal — the letter is where "can you just quickly..." goes to die.

```
You are a practice-management consultant who writes engagement scopes that prevent scope creep instead of documenting it after the fact.

GOAL: Draft the scope section of my engagement letter for [CLIENT + SERVICE] — what is included, what is explicitly excluded, and how out-of-scope requests get handled and priced — plus a reusable scope framework for every future engagement.

CONTEXT: The service: [EXACT DELIVERABLES + FREQUENCY]. My price: [FEE + BILLING RHYTHM]. The "quick favors" clients historically sneak in: [1099 QUESTIONS, PAYROLL FIXES, LOAN APPLICATION DOCS, "QUICK CALLS" — YOUR REAL LIST]. Assumptions the fee depends on: [TRANSACTION VOLUME, CLEAN BOOKS, RESPONSE TIMES].

CONSTRAINTS: Every historical "quick favor" appears by name in included or excluded — no gray zone. Excluded items get a path, not just a no ("available at [RATE]"). Assumptions section states what happens when they break. Plain language a client reads without a lawyer. This is a scope draft, not legal advice — have it reviewed before use.

PROCESS: Sort my real favor-list into included/excluded/priced-extra, write the scope, then stress-test it against each favor: is the answer now obvious?

OUTPUT FORMAT: Scope section ready to paste into my letter, the out-of-scope rate card, and the blank framework for future engagements.
```

**PRO TIP** The rate card does the awkward talking — "happy to, that is covered under the advisory rate" ends the favor economy politely.

### Halfway habit: chain the outputs.

These prompts compound. Paste the close calendar from Prompt 1 into Prompt 6 so the SOPs land on the right close days. Paste the red-flags list from Prompt 7 into Prompt 9 so the scope excludes what onboarding warned you about. Fable 5 holds all of it in one conversation — use that.

## 10 The Workflow Automation Triage

**When to use:** once a quarter — decide which recurring tasks deserve automation and which never will, with honest verdicts.

```
You are an operations consultant for accounting firms who gives honest build-vs-never verdicts — you have seen too many half-built Zaps rot in production.

GOAL: Triage my recurring tasks into automate-now, automate-later, and never-automate — with a concrete first step for each automate-now item using tools I already own.

CONTEXT: My recurring tasks with honest time costs: [TASK / FREQUENCY / MINUTES — CHASING DOCS, CATEGORIZING, REPORT SENDING, INVOICE REMINDERS, DATA ENTRY]. My stack: [QBO/XERO, DEXT/HUBDOC, EMAIL, PORTAL, ANYTHING WITH ZAPIER/N8N ACCESS]. My comfort with tech: [HONEST]. What I tried before that died: [AND WHY].

CONSTRAINTS: Never-automate is a real verdict — anything requiring professional judgment, client trust, or review stays human, say so plainly. No tool purchases in automate-now; my existing stack only. Every verdict shows the math: minutes saved per month vs setup effort. No vendor hype.

PROCESS: Score each task on frequency, rule-basedness, and judgment required, then sort into the three buckets, then spec the first automation step for the top 3.

OUTPUT FORMAT: Triage table (task, verdict, reasoning, monthly minutes), and a first-step build note for each automate-now item.
```

**PRO TIP** If the top automate-now item is document chasing, you already wrote the messages — Prompt 5 becomes the sequence your automation sends.

## Want it done for you?

SkynetLabs builds AI systems for businesses that refuse to be average — automation that chases the documents for you, websites that convert, and content engines that post while you close the books. If you would rather review financials than run prompts, that is literally what we are for.

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### Want the full 40-prompt master list?

This pack is the accounting cut of a bigger system. The complete guide — 40 master prompts across dev, automation, agency growth, content, and strategy — is free on the blog:

https://www.skynetjoe.com/blog/claude-fable-5-prompts-40-master-prompts